

A letter you can keep

Dear Victory,

If I were there today, I would probably pretend I had planned exactly what to say. Then I would see you and forget half of it. I would make a bad joke, wait for that look you give me, and finally tell you this properly: happy birthday, amarachiii.

I still remember our first call. I cannot repeat every word, but I remember the nerves going away and how neither of us seemed ready to hang up. I remember the video calls, the voice notes, and the little goodnights that never felt little to me.

Being in Nigeria while you are in Russia has taught me that four hours can feel longer than four hours. I wish I could be beside you today, without a screen or a network deciding when I get to hear your voice. Until then, I hope these words reach you in the way I mean them.

I am so freaking proud of you. I know you are still figuring things out and life, but I mean who isn't. I hope this year gives you good news, health, luck, money, and all your heart desires, with things to laugh about. And I hope your forehead shines more this year.

I just want you to know I'm always thinking of you, wishing you the best, and grateful to have met a genuine angel like you.

Happy twentieth birthday, Victory.

Favour